

JAVA ROADMAP: **0 TO 25 LPA**



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GENERIC JAVA IS A COMMODITY.

- Fresher median on Naukri 2026: **₹3.5–5 LPA** — service companies. Product startups: **₹6–8 LPA** for the same experience.
- **Same language, different market.** Generic devs get 4–6L. Specialized ones — microservices, fintech, cloud — get 15–25L.
- This roadmap targets **product companies only**. Service companies will never pay 25 LPA in year 5.

₹4–6L

YEAR

- **Core Java before frameworks.** Collections internals, Java 8 streams/lambda, OOP that you understand — not memorized.
- **1 deployed project.** Spring Boot + MySQL + REST API. Live URL + clean GitHub. Not a todo app — a real problem.
- **DSA: 6–8 weeks max.** Arrays, hashmaps, basic trees. Enough to clear startup interviews. Not FAANG prep.

₹7–10L

YEAR

- **Spring Boot depth.** Security (JWT), JPA query optimization, N+1 problem, @ControllerAdvice. Not just @RestController.
- **SQL as a language.** Joins, indexes, execution plans. Product companies interview on this. Most devs at this level still suck at it.
- **Switch jobs — don't wait for increments.** A switch gives 40–60%. Your annual hike gives 10%. The math isn't close.

₹12–16L

YEAR

- **Microservices in production.** Service decomposition, Kafka or RabbitMQ, circuit breakers (Resilience4j). This is table stakes at funded startups.
- **System Design basics.** Caching (Redis), load balancers, DB sharding concepts. Appears in every 12L+ interview. Can't skip it.
- **Docker + AWS basics.** Cloud exposure adds 20–30% salary premium. Most devs at 10L still deploy to bare metal. This is your edge.

₹18–25L

YEAR

- **You're hired for judgment, not code.** Interviews become architecture discussions — design a payment system for 10M transactions/day.
- **Fintech domain = 30–40% premium.** JPMorgan, Goldman Sachs, Razorpay, Zerodha pay ₹18–27L for Java devs with financial systems context.
- **Visibility matters here.** Senior roles are filled via referrals. Write, speak, contribute. Code alone doesn't open these doors.

THE SALARY TRAJECTORY — HONEST.

₹0	Core Java + DSA + 1 project Language foundation. No framework yet.
₹4–6L	First offer — service or seed startup Spring Boot basics + deployed project + SQL.
₹8–12L	First switch — product startup Spring depth + microservices awareness + Kafka/Redis first exposure.
₹14–18L	Second switch — system design required Microservices in prod + Docker/K8s + AWS + domain exposure.
₹20–25L	Senior / Tech Lead — fintech / MNC Architecture decisions + referrals + domain expertise.

SKILLS GOT YOU HERE. DECISIONS GET YOU THERE.

Core Java depth beats Spring Boot breadth — every time

Switch jobs to grow salary. Loyalty doesn't pay in India's market

Fintech domain adds 30–40% on top of equal technical skill

At senior level — visibility and referrals open doors, not just code